

Important information: Our 2017 contract with Premera in Washington State

Providence has made the decision not to renew our current commercial contract with Premera in Washington for 2017. The current contract end date will be Dec. 31, 2016.

We know that not participating in Premera products may be disruptive for some patients and providers, and we don't take this lightly. This decision was reached working in collaboration with our Washington market leaders.

Our goal is to always make the best operational decisions that will allow us to provide quality health care services to the communities we serve. We are communicating about this now to ensure our patients can make the best decisions about their health care plan choices for 2017.

What does this mean for our patients enrolled in a commercial Premera health plan?

This decision does not impact Premera patients using our facilities and physicians for the remainder of this year. All of Providence, Swedish, Kadlec and PacMed's facilities and network of physician practices and clinics will be out of network for Premera enrollees starting on January 1, 2017. This does **not** include the Medicare products, and our Medicare patients will not be impacted.

Our employee medical plans use the Premera Blue Cross network for caregivers in Washington – are they impacted by this decision?

No. This does **not** impact our caregivers/employees who use of our own employed physicians, hospitals and clinics. The HRA and HSA Medical Plans, use the Premera network, but payment for services by our employed providers and facilities are paid by Providence Health Plan, not Premera. The decision also has no impact on caregivers enrolled in Group Health. Should you have other questions about your benefits, you can contact the HR Service Center at 888-687-3753 or submit an AskHR ticket through the [HR portal](#).

Communication

- We are communicating about this decision now to ensure our patients can make the best decisions about their health care plan choices for 2017.
- Our hospital and clinic caregivers will have communication resources to ensure they are able to provide accurate and timely information to our patients.
- All other caregivers will receive this message tomorrow.
- If core leaders or caregivers receive questions, please [click here](#) for talking points and FAQs.
- Additionally, we created an external website – a joint site for all our provider brands: [keepswedish.org](#), [keepkadlec.org](#) and [keeppacmed.org](#) will all direct to [keepprovidence.org](#).